Unconsidered Metrics

Beyond the vital signs being considered (GCS, SBP, DBP, MAP, pulse, temperature, respiratory rate, and FiO_2), clinicians often use additional physiological and laboratory metrics to get a more complete picture of a patient's condition. Oxygen saturation (SpO_2) is commonly used alongside respiratory rate and oxygen delivery measures to assess how effectively oxygen is being absorbed into the bloodstream, and it is a key indicator in detecting hypoxia (World Health Organization, 2011). Blood glucose is another critical metric in acute care because both hypoglycaemia and hyperglycaemia can rapidly cause altered mental status and medical emergencies if not corrected (American Diabetes Association, 2024). In emergency and critical care settings, serum lactate is also frequently measured because elevated levels can indicate tissue hypoperfusion and help identify early shock even when basic vital signs appear normal (Kaukonen et al., 2014). These additional measures complement core vital signs by improving early detection of deterioration and supporting more accurate clinical decision-making.

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